UNIT 42.5 · LEVEL C1

# Hedging

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

*When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.*

## Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 The results _____ that the plan could work.

**a)** prove **b)** guarantee **c)** suggest **d)** demand

2 It is _____ the best option we have.

**a)** arguably **b)** definitely **c)** always **d)** never

3 The film is _____ too long.

**a)** entirely **b)** absolutely **c)** never **d)** somewhat

4 Prices _____ rise in winter.

**a)** always **b)** tend to **c)** must **d)** will

5 That _____ be the reason.

**a)** can't **b)** might **c)** mustn't **d)** shouldn't

6 It is _____ that the figures are wrong.

**a)** certain **b)** proven **c)** clear **d)** possible

7 Which sentence is the most cautious?

**a)** The tax may fail. **b)** The tax will fail.
**c)** The tax fails. **d)** The tax has failed.

8 I'd _____ that it's a fair price.

**a)** guarantee **b)** swear **c)** say **d)** prove

9 The new rule seems _____ unfair.

**a)** extremely **b)** totally **c)** completely **d)** slightly

10 _____ , most students prefer morning classes.

**a)** In general **b)** Always **c)** Never **d)** Absolutely

## Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 This _____ to be the best way.

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12 The test is _____ easy.

13 It _____ be argued that he was right.

14 There is _____ some truth in that.

15 Rents tend _____ rise in summer.

16 The cost is _____ ten dollars.

17 I _____ say it's a bit expensive.

18 _____ speaking, the trip went well.

19 She _____ to be tired today.

20 It is _____ that prices will fall.

## Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **seems / this / to / a / good / be / plan**

_____

22 **could / it / argued / be / that / he / won**

_____

23 **tend / people / to / early / rise / here**

_____

24 **say / I'd / it's / fair / that**

_____

25 **fairly / the / easy / was / test**

_____

26 **speaking / generally / it / is / safe**

_____

27 **likely / is / it / that / will / rain / it**

_____

28 **appears / report / the / to / be / wrong**

_____

## Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the best option.*
The cake is _____ sweet.
Options: **entirely** / **exactly** / **slightly** / **totally**

30 *Choose the best option.*
It _____ to be a mistake.
Options: **wants** / **seems** / **forgets** / **refuses**

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**31** *Choose the best option.*
She _____ be late.
Options: **is** / **does** / **did** / **might**

**32** *Choose the best option.*
_____ , it is a good idea.
Options: **Absolutely** / **Never** / **To some extent** / **Always**

**33** *Choose the best option.*
Prices _____ to go up.
Options: **need** / **force** / **tend** / **avoid**

**34** *Choose the best option.*
I would _____ that he is right.
Options: **promise** / **swear** / **confirm** / **argue**

**35** *Choose the best option.*
The room is _____ small.
Options: **hence** / **whose** / **rather** / **once**

## Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

**36** Match the hedge to its meaning.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. roughly _____ | **A.** it can be argued |
| 2. arguably _____ | **B.** usually do |
| 3. somewhat _____ | **C.** about |
| 4. tend to _____ | **D.** to a small degree |

**37** Match each strong sentence to a hedged one.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. It is wrong _____ | **A.** We appear to have lost |
| 2. He lied _____ | **B.** It may be wrong |
| 3. It works _____ | **C.** He seems to have lied |
| 4. We lost _____ | **D.** It tends to work |

**38** Match the hedge to its type.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. might _____ | **A.** phrase |
| 2. seems _____ | **B.** adverb |
| 3. fairly _____ | **C.** lexical verb |
| 4. in general _____ | **D.** modal verb |

**39** Match each word to a softer word.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. definitely _____ | **A.** usually |
| 2. always _____ | **B.** roughly |
| 3. exactly _____ | **C.** partly |
| 4. completely _____ | **D.** possibly |

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**40** Match the phrase to its use.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. I'd say _____ | **A.** suggest an idea |
| 2. to some extent _____ | **B.** give an opinion softly |
| 3. it could be argued _____ | **C.** talk about most cases |
| 4. generally speaking _____ | **D.** partly agree |

## Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

**41** It tends being cold in May. Correct word: _____

**42** The results are somewhat surprised. Correct word: _____

**43** It seem that he is late. Correct word: _____

**44** They might to arrive late. Correct word: _____

**45** It is relative cheap here. Correct word: _____

**46** Generally speak, it works well. Correct word: _____

**47** I'd said it is fair. Correct word: _____

**48** There might be somes problems. Correct word: _____

**49** The result is likelihood true. Correct word: _____

**50** He appears being unhappy. Correct word: _____

## Your score

*Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.*

| A | B | C | D | E | F | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ____ / 10 | ____ / 10 | ____ / 8 | ____ / 7 | ____ / 5 | ____ / 10 | ____ **/ 50** |

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UNIT 42.5 · LEVEL C1

# Answer Key

Hedging

## Part A · Multiple Choice

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **c)** suggest | Suggest is cautious. |
| 2 | **a)** arguably | Arguably softens a claim. |
| 3 | **d)** somewhat | Somewhat means a little. |
| 4 | **b)** tend to | Tend to = usually. |
| 5 | **b)** might | Might shows possibility. |
| 6 | **d)** possible | Possible is cautious. |
| 7 | **a)** The tax may fail. | May shows possibility. |
| 8 | **c)** say | I'd say softens an opinion. |
| 9 | **d)** slightly | Slightly reduces strength. |
| 10 | **a)** In general | In general allows exceptions. |

## Part B · Fill in the Gaps

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | **appears** (or: seems) | Appear softens claims. |
| 12 | **fairly** (or: relatively, rather, reasonably, quite) | Fairly reduces strength. |
| 13 | **could** (or: can, might) | Could softens a claim. |
| 14 | **probably** (or: perhaps, possibly) | Probably softens certainty. |
| 15 | **to** | Tend + to-infinitive. |
| 16 | **roughly** (or: approximately, around, about) | Roughly means about. |
| 17 | **would** (or: 'd) | Would softens opinions. |
| 18 | **Generally** (or: Broadly) | Generally means in most cases. |
| 19 | **seems** (or: appears) | Seem softens claims. |
| 20 | **likely** (or: possible, probable) | Likely shows probability. |

## Part C · Unscramble the Words

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 21 | **This seems to be a good plan.** | Seem + to be. |
| 22 | **It could be argued that he won.** | Could softens. |
| 23 | **People here tend to rise early.** | Tend + to. |
| 24 | **I'd say that it's fair.** | I'd say softens. |
| 25 | **The test was fairly easy.** | Fairly + adjective. |
| 26 | **Generally speaking, it is safe.** | Generally speaking. |

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| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 27 | **It is likely that it will rain.** | Likely shows probability. |
| 28 | **The report appears to be wrong.** | Appear + to be. |

## Part D · Choose and Complete

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 29 | **slightly** | Slightly softens. |
| 30 | **seems** | Seem softens. |
| 31 | **might** | Might = possibly. |
| 32 | **To some extent** | Partly true. |
| 33 | **tend** | Tend to. |
| 34 | **argue** | Would argue is cautious. |
| 35 | **rather** | Rather softens. |

## Part E · Matching

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 36 | **1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B** | roughly – about; arguably – it can be argued; somewhat – to a small degree; tend to – usually do<br>Check each meaning. |
| 37 | **1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A** | It is wrong – It may be wrong; He lied – He seems to have lied; It works – It tends to work; We lost – We appear to have lost<br>Soften the claim. |
| 38 | **1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A** | might – modal verb; seems – lexical verb; fairly – adverb; in general – phrase<br>Think about word class. |
| 39 | **1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C** | definitely – possibly; always – usually; exactly – roughly; completely – partly<br>Soften each word. |
| 40 | **1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C** | I'd say – give an opinion softly; to some extent – partly agree; it could be argued – suggest an idea; generally speaking – talk about most cases<br>Think about the purpose. |

## Part F · Find the Error

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 41 | **to be** | Tend + to-infinitive. |
| 42 | **surprising** | Use the -ing adjective. |
| 43 | **seems** | It takes -s. |
| 44 | **might arrive** (or: may arrive, could arrive) | No to after might. |
| 45 | **relatively** | Adverb modifies adjective. |
| 46 | **speaking** | Generally speaking. |
| 47 | **say** | I'd say + clause. |
| 48 | **some** | Some has no plural -s. |
| 49 | **likely** | Use the adjective likely. |
| 50 | **to be** | Appear + to-infinitive. |

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